[LIT-POEM-007] Ngala Mirin

Translation: The Life and Grace of a Tangkhul Maiden

Work Type: POEM | Creator: Iknguira L. Shimray | Year: 2020
Village: Hunphun | Dialect: Hunphun / Standard Tangkhul | Book ID: None
Publisher / Source: Hunphun Literary Circle, Ukhrul
Clearance: Author Permitted | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

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Themes: Poetic celebration of Tangkhul maidenhood (*Ngala Mirin*), Customary filial respect, fireside instruction, and domestic grace, The

Structure & Meter: Eight-line pastoral lyric with parallel metric structure and evocative

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Critical Overview: A standout lyrical piece by Iknguira L. Shimray
celebrated in Ukhrul literary circles for capturing the delicate emotional

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Indigenous Tangkhul Literary Text / Stanzas:

Ngala mirin khamatha, chiyan kashungwui won thada,
Luirim chonkashan shanda shanaonao ning-ngachei kashung.
Meiphung-li pamda avawui tui theida khangarang,
Kashan-kachon eili ararawui ngashan thada kapikathat;

English Translation & Literary Rendering:

The life and grace of a maiden, blooming like wild lilies when spring re
Draped in the proud woven stripes of the Luirim shawl, her heart remains
By the warm fireside she absorbs the gentle counsel of her mother,
Weaving the ancestral patterns of her clan upon the rhythmic backstrap l

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Key Poetic & Literary Vocabulary Terms:

* Ngala mirin : The life, journey, and customary passage of an unm
* Ning-kacham : Purity of conscience and upright modesty
* Kong-khamatha : Pure, unpolluted crystal mountain stream